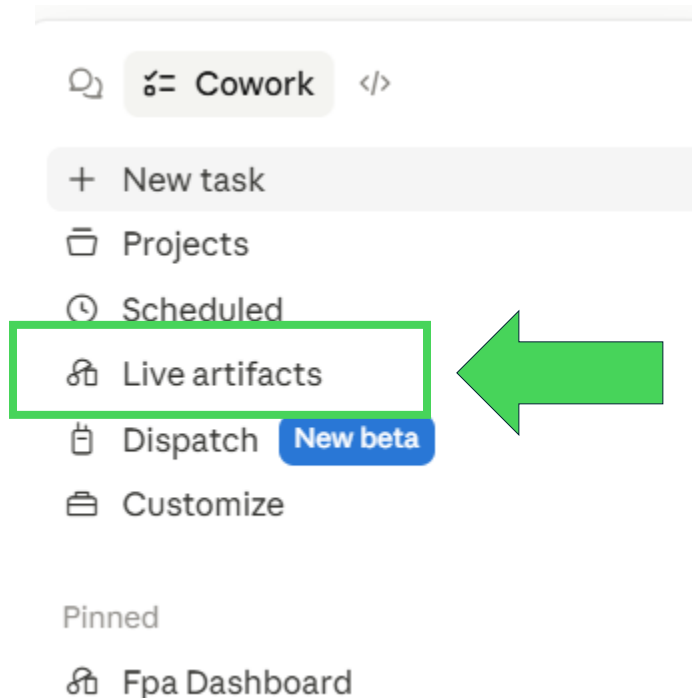


Claude Live Artifacts

A practical guide for Finance and FP&A teams

By [Christian Martinez](#)



Claude launched live artifacts

It is a new feature that lets you instantly build interactive financial dashboards that connect directly to your existing systems

How to use them in Finance or FP&A?

Here is my guide:

If you work in Finance or FP&A, most of your week is spent answering the same questions with slightly different data: what are actuals vs. budget, where is variance widening, which deals are slipping, which vendors are over-spending, and how does this month compare to last.

Live artifacts are built for exactly that rhythm, you ask once, and the page keeps answering every time you open it.

So what is a live artifact?

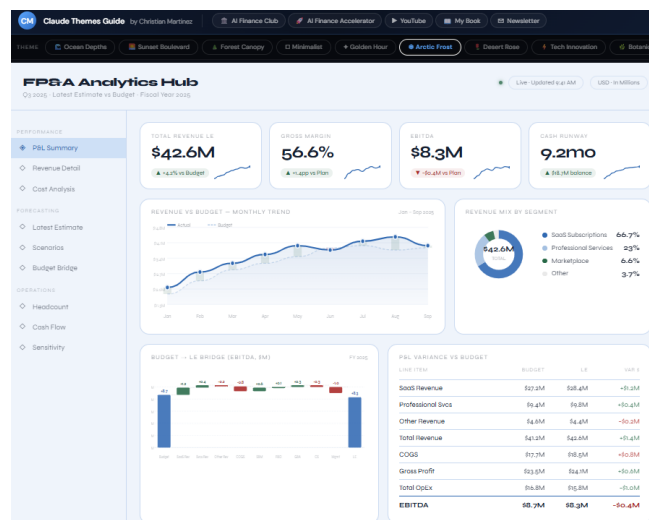
A live artifact is a persistent, interactive webpage that lives in your Cowork sidebar. Unlike a one-off chat answer, a live artifact:

- **Persists across sessions** — it stays open in its own tab and you can return to it anytime, on any device.
- **Pulls fresh data** — it calls your connected tools (MCP connectors) each time you open it, so you always see current numbers.
- **Is interactive** — you can filter, search, drill into line items, and take actions right from the page.
- **Replaces repetitive questions** — instead of re-asking “what’s our MRR?” every Monday, you open the artifact and it fetches the latest automatically.

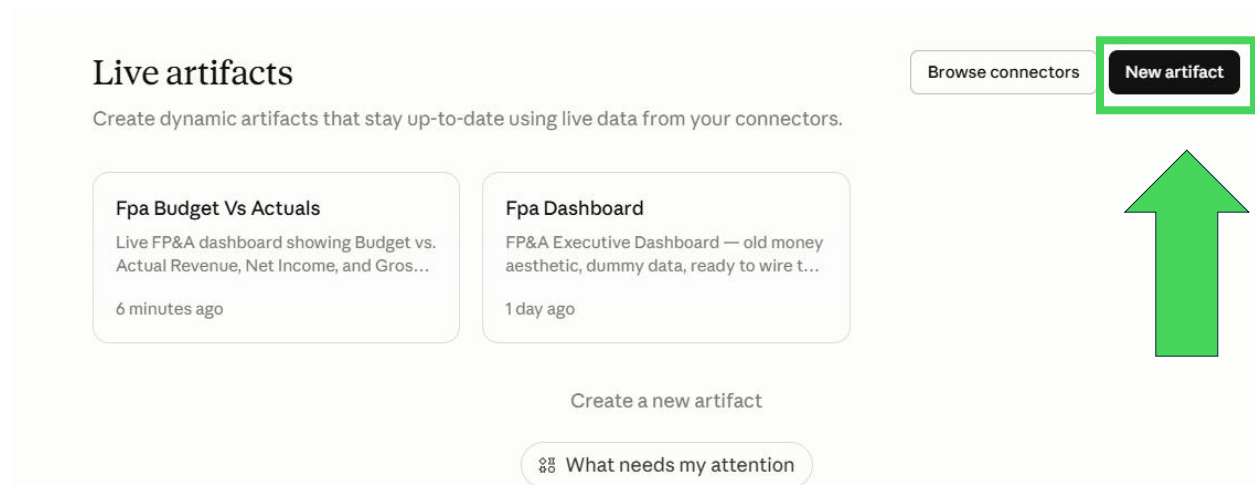
Think of it as turning a smart chat answer into a personal dashboard page that is always up to date, somewhere between a chat thread and a BI tool, but built in minutes instead of weeks.

How to Build a Live Artifact for Finance and FP&A

So let’s say that you want to build a Dashboard like this from a live Database:



Step 1: Open Cowork and click on “New Artifact”



Step 2: Then you prompt!

You can use (and modify) this example prompt:

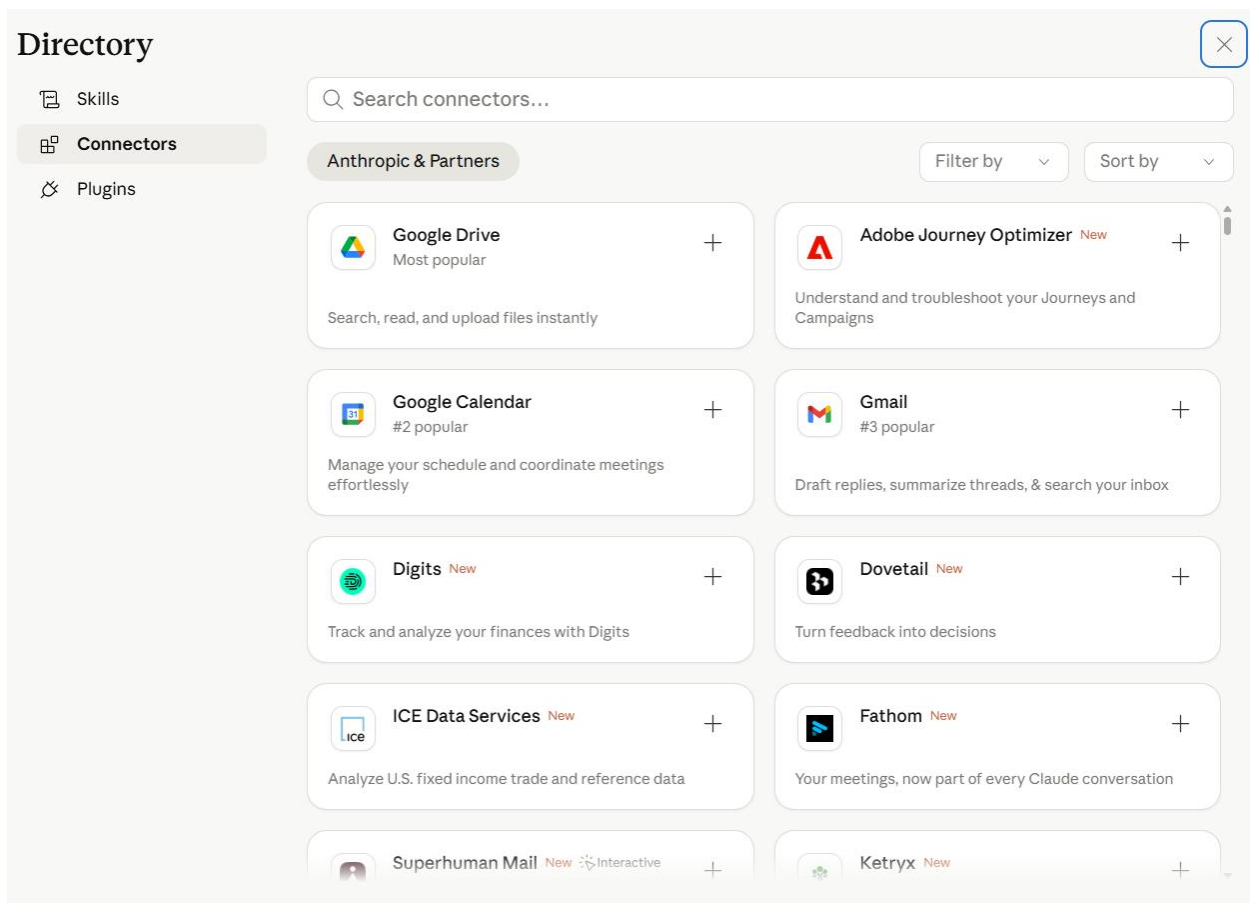
"Build a live FP&A Analytics Hub from my Google Sheet [link]. Include: KPI cards for Revenue, Gross Margin, EBITDA, and Cash Runway with vs-budget variance; a monthly Revenue vs Budget trend line chart; revenue mix donut chart by segment; a Budget-to-LE bridge waterfall chart; and a P&L variance table showing Budget, Latest Estimate, and Variance columns. Add a left sidebar with sections for Performance, Forecasting, and Operations. Use a clean, modern design with an Arctic Frost color theme. Refresh all data automatically when the sheet updates."

You can also start with something very simple like:

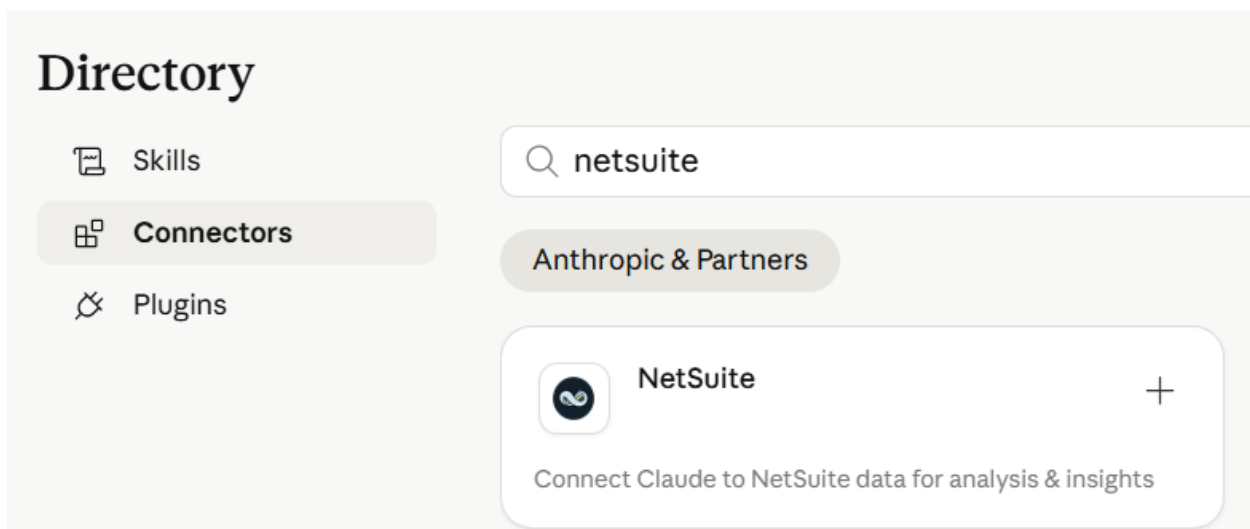
Build a live FP&A dashboard from my Google Sheet [paste link or name]. Show budget vs actuals by department, and refresh automatically when the sheet changes.

Step 3: You use connectors to connect to the systems you want the data to flow from.

Some of the connector possibilities:



For example, from the Connectors directory, search for “netsuite” and select the Oracle NetSuite connector:



Review the connector detail page before connecting. It shows which tools the connector exposes — for NetSuite that includes record-level reads and writes (ns_getRecord, ns_updateRecord), saved searches (ns_listSavedSearches), and report runs (ns_runReport, ns_listAllReports). Click Connect and authorize against your NetSuite account.

**NetSuite**

Connect Claude to NetSuite data for analysis & insights

Connect

A flexible and scalable way to connect Claude to NetSuite and use AI to query and analyze NetSuite data.

Developed by [Oracle NetSuite](#)

Only use connectors from developers you trust. Anthropic does not control which tools developers make available and cannot verify that they will work as intended or that they won't change.

Tools 10

ns_createRecord

ns_getRecord

ns_getRecordTypeMetadata

ns_updateRecord

ns_getSubsidiaries

ns_listAllReports

ns_runReport

ns_listSavedSearches

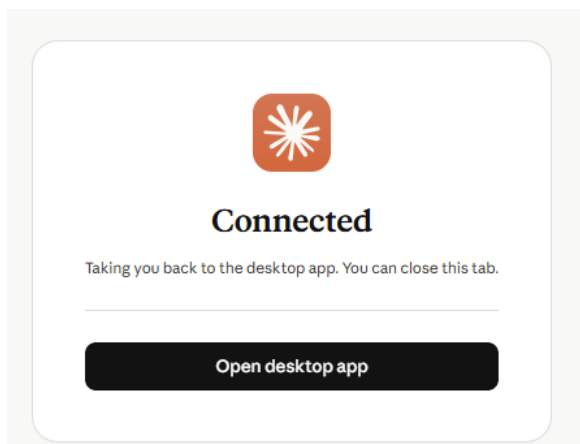
+2 more

Details

Author
[Oracle NetSuite](#)

More info
[Documentation](#)
[Support](#)
[Privacy Policy](#)

Remember always read all the terms and conditions before connecting!



In my case I am using a testing Excel file with synthetic data

Budget Testing File

File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Extensions Help

100% | \$ % .0 .00 123 | Default... | 10 | B I

K17

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	
	Table1							
1	Month	Budgeted Revenue	Actual Revenue	Budgeted COGS	Actual COGS	Budgeted Operating Income	Operating Expenses	Budgeted Income
2	January	921958	1138468	499041	282747	316216	340174	
3	February	946867	925203	305311	403855	211394	374555	
4	March	931932	941335	403355	470222	269092	344358	
5	April	1165838	1028167	484779	345725	203890	268555	
6	May	1059178	791090	385305	409981	241606	237159	
7	June	919879	1079365	459765	364654	287313	330510	
8	July	910268	814820	430608	446845	341699	326530	
9	August	1007892	1012913	456730	399346	208792	300077	
10	September	854886	1071879	384478	347435	374073	255920	
11	October	937337	944027	422537	336886	354969	418193	
12	November	887498	1077069	449503	346803	268148	239457	
13	December	1174871	1002709	430523	311551	324243	417629	

Step 4: It will ask you for confirmation



Claude wants to use Search files from Google Drive

You can also see progress and what is connected on the top right:

Progress ▼



See task progress for longer tasks.

Working folder ▼



View and open files created during this task.

Context ▼

Connectors

 Google Drive

 mcp-registry

Step 5: Cowork will build the live artifact (in this case a dashboard) for you

Building it now:

 create_artifact

▼

 Using cowork... · 6s

Then you check your dashboard and can iterate to improve it!

Full Year Income Statement — Monthly Detail

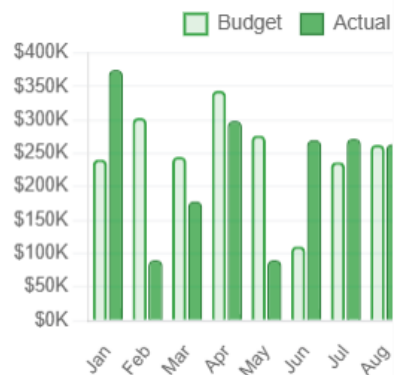
ACTUAL REVENUE

\$12.06M**+2.9%** vs budget
\$11.72MACTUAL NET
INCOME**\$2.78M****-4.4%** vs budget
\$2.90MGROSS MARGIN
%**60.0%****-0.0pp** vs budget
60.0%REVENUE
VARIANCE \$**+\$342K**Full year
cumulative

REVENUE — BUDGET VS. ACTUAL



NET INCOME — BUDGET VS. ACTUAL

 Created artifact: fpa-budget-vs-actuals

Your FP&A dashboard is live in the sidebar. Here's what it includes:

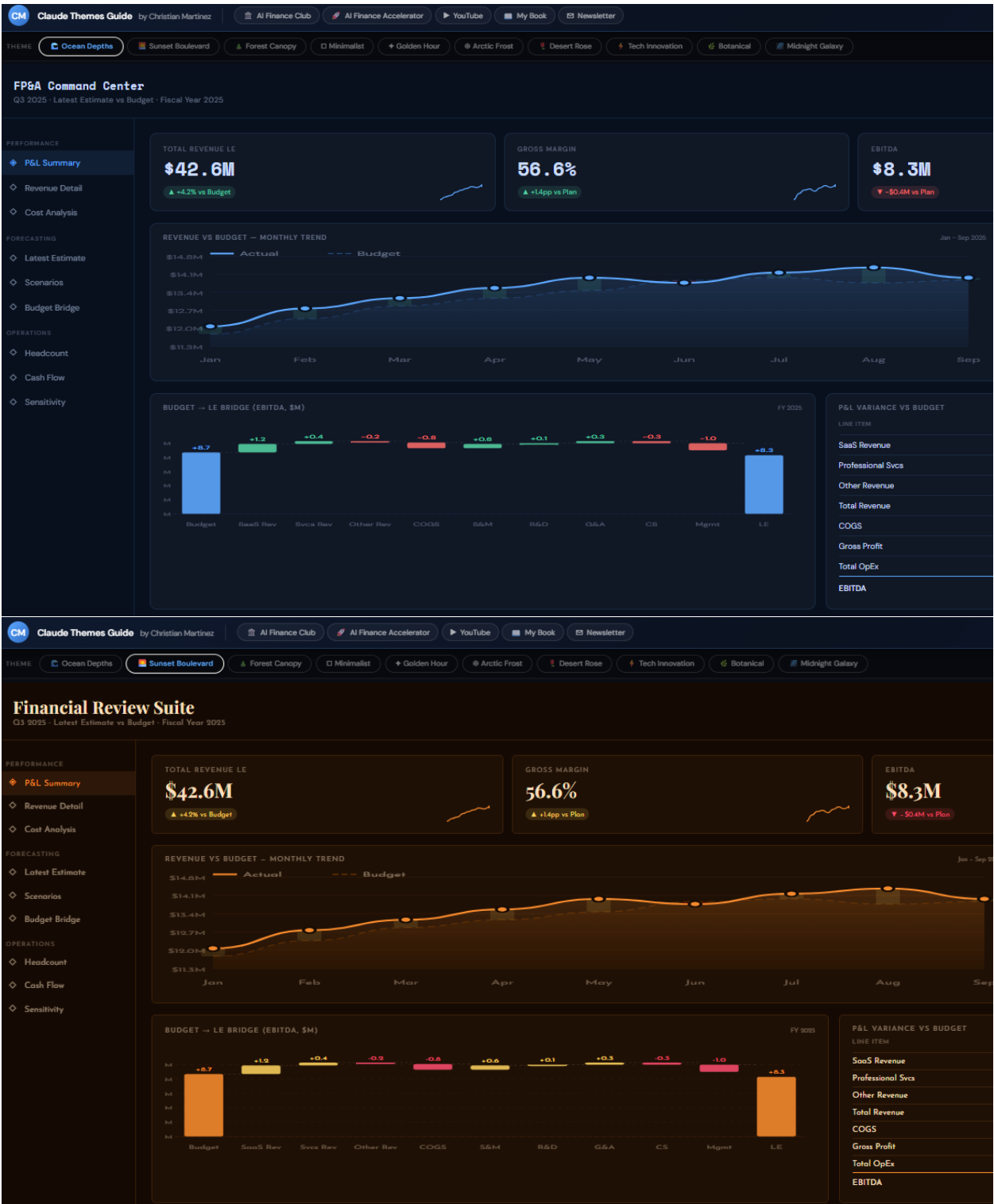
4 KPI cards — Actual Revenue, Actual Net Income, Gross Margin %, and Revenue Variance \$, each showing the delta vs. budget at a glance.

3 charts — Revenue (Budget vs. Actual bars), Net Income (Budget vs. Actual bars), and a Gross Margin % trend line for both.

Monthly P&L table — all 12 months with variance % columns, color-coded green/red, plus a totals row.

Some ideas for User Interfaces of dashboards in my Theme Guide:

FP&A Executive Dashboard Theme Showcase — 10 Interactive Designs | Claude



CM

Claude Themes Guide

by Christian Martinez

AI Finance Club

AI Finance Accelerator

YouTube

My Book

Newsletter

THEME

Ocean Depths

Sunset Boulevard

Forest Canopy

Minimalist

Golden Hour

Arctic Frost

Desert Rose

Tech Innovation

Botanical

Midnight Galaxy

Financial Review Suite

Q3 2025 - Latest Estimate vs Budget - Fiscal Year 2025

PERFORMANCE

P&L Summary

Revenue Detail

Cost Analysis

FORECASTING

Latest Estimate

Scenarios

Budget Bridge

OPERATIONS

Headcount

Cash Flow

Sensitivity

TOTAL REVENUE LE

\$42.6M

▲ +4.2% vs Budget

GROSS MARGIN

56.6%

▲ +1.4pp vs Plan

EBITDA

\$8.3M

▼ -\$0.6M vs Plan

REVENUE VS BUDGET - MONTHLY TREND

Jan - Sep 2025

Actual

Budget

Jan

Feb

Mar

Apr

May

Jun

Jul

Aug

Sep

BUDGET → LE BRIDGE (EBITDA, \$M)

FY 2025

Budget

SaaS Rev

Svc Rev

Other Rev

COGS

S&M

R&D

G&A

CS

Mgmt

LE

+8.7

+1.2

+0.4

-0.2

-0.8

+0.6

+0.1

+0.3

-0.3

-1.0

+8.3

P&L VARIANCE VS BUDGET

LINE ITEM

SaaS Revenue

Professional Svcs

Other Revenue

Total Revenue

COGS

Gross Profit

Total OpEx

EBITDA

What are other Finance and FP&A Use Cases and Prompts:

DASHBOARDS

1. Cash Flow & Treasury

"Build a live Treasury Dashboard from my Google Sheet [link]. Show cash balance, burn rate, and runway as KPI cards; a 13-week cash flow forecast chart; inflows vs outflows waterfall; and an AP/AR aging table. Add variance vs forecast and auto-refresh when the sheet updates."

2. SaaS Metrics

"Build a live SaaS Metrics Dashboard from my Google Sheet [link]. Show ARR, MRR, Churn Rate, and NRR as KPI cards; a cohort retention heatmap; MRR movement waterfall (new, expansion, contraction, churn); and a revenue by customer segment table. Refresh automatically."

OTHER CAPABILITIES

3. Slack Deal Monitor

"Monitor my #deals Slack channel and build a live deal tracker that shows all deals mentioned, their status, owner, and value in a sortable table. Flag any deal that hasn't had an update in 5+ days in red."

4. Gmail Executive Briefing

"Every time I open this, scan my last 24 hours of emails and generate a CFO morning briefing: urgent items needing my response, key financial figures mentioned, and pending approvals — sorted by priority."

5. Google Drive Contract Analyzer

"Scan my Google Drive folder [name] containing vendor contracts and build a live table showing each contract's vendor name, value, renewal date, and payment terms. Highlight any contracts expiring within 90 days."

Managing your artifacts

Each live artifact can be pinned, renamed, moved into a project, scheduled to refresh on a cadence, or turned into a reusable skill. You can also archive or delete artifacts that have outlived their usefulness.

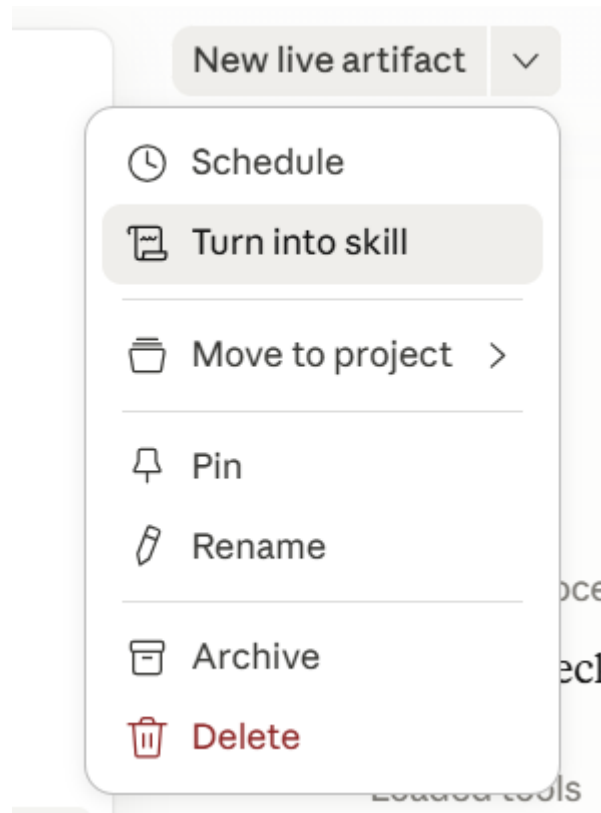


Figure 6. The artifact action menu — schedule, turn into skill, move to project, pin, rename, archive, or delete.

The option that pays off most often for Finance teams is **Turn into skill**. Once an artifact is stable (say, your month-end P&L review), converting it into a skill lets the rest of your team invoke the same logic with one prompt, without having to rebuild it or share a link. Scheduling is a close second — an AR aging artifact refreshed every Monday at 8am is a zero-effort Monday morning review.

Tips for building artifacts that actually get used

1. **Start from a real weekly question.** The best first artifact replaces something you already reopen on a schedule. If you wouldn't open it on a Monday, it won't get used on a Tuesday.
2. **Keep the first version small.** One tile, one source, one clear question. Expand once you've used it for a week.
3. **Be explicit about thresholds.** "Flag variance > 5%" is easier to act on than "show variance."
4. **Pin the ones you open daily.** Archive the ones you don't. A cluttered artifact list defeats the point.
5. **Promote stable artifacts to skills.** If three people on your team would find it useful, it should be a skill, not a bookmark.
6. **Audit what the artifact is reading.** For anything touching financials, open the connector detail page at least once and confirm the tool scopes match your controls.